TEN

‘I don’t think I’ll pass,’ I said to Anuradha, panicking.

‘You definitely won’t if you keep whining like this,’ Anuradha said as she passed the book to me. ‘Now revise quickly.’

‘I don’t know what to focus on,’ I lamented as I turned the pages of the book. ‘Safety procedures or technical data? Only four hours are left for the exam!’

‘There’s barely any time! Just go through what you can,’ Anuradha advised as she walked out of the room.

The first light of the sun lit up the night sky as I sat there wondering what to do. Anuradha had done her best to make me understand most of the concepts, but to be able to write, I had to memorize the language of the book. The scope of the syllabus was so wide that I knew I wouldn’t be able to read everything in just four hours. So I had to be selective, I had to follow my instincts. Honestly, my instincts, too, had given up on me at that time. It added to my frustration and I threw the book away. I wished Papaji was there to help me.

* * *

April 1987